Week 06 — Before You Come: Mama Titi's Menu

100L · Semester 1 · HTML I — Structure · Preparation: 35 minutes

The story so far

Last week, at **Tiny Lamp Studio**, you fixed Mama Titi's order slip in VS Code and showed her a Hello World page in the browser. She liked it, and she wants more.

> **Tolu, senior developer** · Friday, 5:45 pm
>
> Mama Titi wants a real menu page: her prices, a photo of the jollof and a link to her CampusChop shop. Funmi has typed the words already. On Tuesday we turn them into a page with **HTML**, the language every web page is written in. Have a look at how HTML works this weekend. And start thinking about a page of your own.

In class you build Mama Titi's menu with headings, lists, a photo, a link and a price table. Then you start your own **portfolio**, a page that shows who you are and what you have built. This week it holds structure only; colours and layout come later. Class lasts **2 hours**. This preparation happens before class and is not graded.

> **Bring:** your laptop and charger if available, a notebook, a pen and these downloaded notes. No laptop? Tell the tutor so you can take a turn on a shared machine.

1. Find the shape of a page · 8 minutes

(paper) Every useful document has a shape before it has a look. Here is part of a notice from a departmental noticeboard, typed with no formatting:

```
Department of Computing
Notice to all 100L students
Practical sessions
Bring your laptop and charger
Bring your student ID
Arrive ten minutes early
How to collect your lab pass
Fill in the form at the office
Pay at the bursary
Show your receipt and collect the pass
Lab times
Group A Monday 10 am Lab 2
Group B Tuesday 2 pm Lab 1
```

1. Copy it into your notebook, or write on this page. Circle the **one main title**.
2. Underline the **section titles**.

3. Mark each line that is an item in a list with a dot (•). If the order of a list matters, number its lines instead.
4. The last two lines hold the same three kinds of fact. Draw them as a grid with a heading for each column.

Record: main title _____ · how many sections _____ · which list needs numbers _____ · my column headings _____ / _____ / _____ / _____

2. Read with a question · 15 minutes

Read in this order and stop at the boundaries below. You don't need to install anything.

1. **MDN — Basic HTML syntax** (10 min). Read "Anatomy of an HTML element", "Nesting elements", "Void elements" and "Attributes" up to "Adding attributes to an element". The **Play** buttons on the code examples need internet; reading the code is enough. **Skip** anything about CSS. **Question:** What is the difference between a **tag** and an **element**? Answer in one sentence.
2. **MDN — HTML table basics** (5 min). Read "What is a table?" and "When should you avoid HTML tables?" only. **Question:** Your lab times fit a table. Why would the whole noticeboard page *not* be built as a table?

3. Get ready for your portfolio · 10 minutes

Your portfolio is a page about you and your work. You start it in class.

1. **(paper)** Write three or four **section titles** your page could have, such as a section about you, what you can do, and what you have learnt so far. Use your own words.
2. **(laptop or phone)** Choose **one image** you are happy to put on your page. It doesn't need to be your face: a photo of something you made, a drawing, or a screenshot of last week's Hello World page all work. Use only an image you made or have the right to share.
3. **(laptop)** Put the image in a folder you can find. Check its full name, including the extension you learnt about in week 4, such as `.jpg` or `.png`. If you can, rename it in lowercase with no spaces, such as `my-hello-page.png`.

Record: my section titles _____ · my image file name _____

No laptop? Do step 1 on paper, and describe in words the image you would use.

4. Find last week's page · 2 minutes

(laptop) Find your week 5 lab folder, `edupoint-week05-lab`, and check that its `index.html` still opens in your browser. You may link to it from your portfolio.

Record: last week's page opens: yes / no

> **Offline route:** Tasks 1, 3 and 4 need no internet. For Task 2, use this summary. An HTML **element** is usually an **opening tag** such as `<p>`, some content, and a **closing tag** such as `</p>`. The **tag** is just the label in angle brackets; the **element** is the whole thing. Elements can sit inside other elements, which is called **nesting**. A few elements, such as `<img>`, have no content and no closing tag. **Attributes** add information inside the opening tag, such as `src="photo.jpg"`. A **table** holds data in rows and columns, such as prices or timetables. Don't use tables to arrange a page: that is CSS's job, and layout tables confuse screen readers.

Ready check

- I have found the title, sections, lists and grid in the noticeboard notice.
- I can say, in one sentence, the difference between a tag and an element.
- I have chosen an image for my portfolio and know its full file name.

- I can say, in one sentence, what Mama Titi needs from Tiny Lamp this week. I have not used AI to answer the tasks.

Sources

- MDN contributors: Basic HTML syntax and HTML table basics. Links checked 12 November 2026.
- The notice, the activities and the story are original. Tiny Lamp Studio, Mama Titi and her canteen are made up.